

## 3.2 Threats to the Antarctic ecosystem and how they can be managed

### « RECALL AND CONNECT 2 «

Some people believe that there are reserves of fossil fuels located beneath the Antarctic ice sheets. The Antarctic Treaty states that no single country can rule Antarctica and forbids any country from mining resources, such as fossil fuels. See if you can answer these questions linked to [Topic 10, 'Resource provision'](#).

- a** What are fossil fuels?
- b** What are the advantages and disadvantages of using fossil fuels?

- 1** Copy the Antarctic food chain in Figure 3.1. Then, add the species listed in Table 3.1 to the correct place in Figure 3.1.



**Figure 3.1:** Flow diagram showing an Antarctic food chain

|                        |
|------------------------|
| Smaller toothed whales |
| Phytoplankton          |
| Penguins               |
| Krill                  |



**Table 3.1:** Antarctic species

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**2** Under international agreements, which of the following activities are banned in Antarctica?

- collecting scientific data
- military operations
- disposal of nuclear waste
- tourism
- commercial fishing
- mining

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**2** Use the words below to fill in the gaps about international agreements to protect wildlife in Antarctica.

**International Association of Antarctic Tour Operators (IAATO)**

**Polar Code      Marine Protected Areas (MPAs)**

**International Whaling Commission (IWC)**

The \_\_\_\_\_ imposed a quota system in the 1970s on all parties hunting whales. Two large \_\_\_\_\_ have been established in the Antarctic to protect biodiversity through protecting those areas from commercial activities. The International Maritime Organization implemented a \_\_\_\_\_ in 2017 that limits the operation of very large cruise ships in Antarctica. The \_\_\_\_\_ is working on putting laws in place to manage tourism to the region to limit harm caused by human activity.